Chapter 3: The TOGAF Standard

Study Guide, based on Mastering the TOGAF Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 3 (pp. 31-52)

Overview

Chapter 3 (pp. 31-52) explains what the TOGAF Standard actually consists of. Section 3.1 defines it as an open, vendor-neutral EA framework whose structure mirrors an organization's Architecture Capability (pp. 32-36). Section 3.2 walks through the six documents of the **Fundamental Content** (pp. 36-40). Section 3.3 covers the faster-moving **Series Guides** (pp. 40-42). Section 3.4 describes the **TOGAF Library** and its categories (pp. 43-46). Section 3.5 lists the key advantages of using the Standard (pp. 46-50), and Section 3.6 summarizes (pp. 50-52). Leave with this idea: the Standard is modular by design. You can adopt the parts you need, starting with the ADM, and tailoring is "more of a necessity than an option" (pp. 39-40, 52). Chapter 3 is part of the PINK and GREEN reading tours (p. 31).

> **Reading note:** Most of this chapter describes the Standard's structure, which is factual. The Netflix/video-store capability example (pp. 34-35) is Jager's own illustration. The advantages in 3.5 are presented as the book's view, supported by one cited study (O'Higgins) (p. 48). Keep three similar names apart: the **TOGAF Library** (guidance portfolio), the **Reference Library** (a class of the Architecture Repository that the TOGAF Library supports), and **The Open Group Library** (which contains the TOGAF Library) (pp. 43-44).

Detailed Section Breakdown

Chapter Opener (p. 31)

- **"Standard" in the name.** The 10th Edition is the first with "Standard" in its title, which fits The Open Group's role as a vendor-neutral standards body and sends a clear message: "this is a standard, for Enterprise Architecture" (p. 31).
- **Composition.** About six core documents, supplemented by Series Guides. The complete set, together with the TOGAF Reference Library, is part of the TOGAF Library (p. 31).

3.1 What Is the TOGAF Standard (pp. 32-36)

- **Definition.** An open EA framework, developed and maintained by The Open Group, describing the general approach to establishing an Enterprise Architecture as a series of independent but closely related documents (p. 32).
- **Why a standard.** The Open Group works with customers, suppliers, and consortia to capture requirements and share best practice. Standards ensure "openness, interoperability, and consensus" (p. 32).
- **Product- and vendor-independent.** It can be applied to any type of architecture in almost any context. The TOGAF Library adds practical, context-specific guidance (p. 33).
- **Structure mirrors the Architecture Capability.** In Figure 3-2, the ADM sits at the centre as "the heart of the framework", surrounded by Architecture Content, techniques, and applications of the method, all inside the Architecture Capability (pp. 33-34; ADM in Ch. 12, capability in Ch. 9).
- **Inputs and outputs.** Market-driven business needs feed the Standard as problems and challenges. The Standard returns business solutions and refined business needs. Both streams update the business vision and drivers (p. 34).

- **Business capabilities.** Changes to the business or operating model often require new business capabilities, which represent the change and provide business value (p. 34).
- **Example: video store to streaming (Figure 3-3).** Store Management and Physical Product Management become Bandwidth Management and Digital Product Management. Contract Management keeps its name but changes content (suppliers become studios). Invoice Management barely changes (pp. 34-35).
- **Versatility.** It supports different architecture styles, integrates with other standards, adapts to industries and use cases, and is highly scalable. Reduced to essentials, it is Fundamental Content plus Series Guides (p. 36).

3.2 Fundamental Content (pp. 36-40)

Document	What it covers	Where the book expands it
Introduction and Core Concepts	Core terms and definitions: the EA definition, architecture domains, a brief ADM overview, deliverables, artifacts, building blocks, the Enterprise Continuum, Architecture Repository, Content Framework	Ch. 4-7, 11 (p. 37)
Architecture Development Method (ADM)	The ADM cycle, adapting it, scoping an architecture problem, integration. "The heart of the TOGAF Standard": flexible, iterative, adaptable	Ch. 12 (p. 37)
ADM Techniques	Techniques for applying the ADM, e.g., Architecture Principles, Stakeholder Management, Architecture Alternatives and Trade-Offs	Ch. 14 (p. 38)
Applying the ADM	Adapting the ADM to process styles (iteration) and specialized architectures such as Security	Ch. 13 (p. 38)
Architecture Content	The Architecture Content Framework: building blocks and artifacts (catalogs, matrices, diagrams, maps), plus the Enterprise, Architecture, and Solutions Continua	Ch. 5-7 (pp. 38-39)
EA Capability and Governance	The Architecture Capability Framework (structure, roles, processes) and a Governance Framework that serves as an adaptable starting point	Ch. 8-10 (p. 39)

- **Building blocks vs. artifacts.** Building blocks are the core components (processes, information concepts, data entities, application systems). Artifacts are the deliverables produced during the ADM, such as catalogs, matrices, diagrams, and maps (pp. 38-39).
- **Why separate documents.** So that specialist areas can be studied and addressed in isolation. They form a cohesive whole but "don't have to be adopted all at once". You can cherry-pick, e.g., use the ADM but skip the Architecture Capability components (pp. 39-40).
- **Two scenarios for gradual adoption.** A new adopter starts with core areas such as the ADM. An organization with an existing framework blends TOGAF parts into what already works (p. 40).

3.3 Series Guides (pp. 40-42)

- **Purpose.** Better guidance for developing *useful* EA that supports stakeholders' decisions and organizational change (p. 40).
- **Range of topics.** Setting up an EA Capability, Business and Security Architecture, agile methods, the digital enterprise, business models, business capabilities, business scenarios, agile delivery via time-boxed increments (Ch. 18), reference models, EA maturity assessment, and project-management guidance (pp. 40-42).
- **Not all are relevant.** "Not all the TOGAF Series Guides will be relevant in every situation", but architects should know what exists (p. 41).

- **Faster evolution.** They are driven by The Open Group Architecture Forum through incremental delivery, so they respond to industry trends faster than the core (p. 41).

3.4 The TOGAF Library (pp. 43-46)

- **What it is.** A portfolio of guidelines, templates, patterns, and reference material that accelerates new architectures. The TOGAF Documentation Set is part of it, and it is itself part of The Open Group Library (p. 43).
- **Link to the Architecture Repository.** It supports the repository's **Reference Library** class (p. 44; see Ch. 7).

Library category	Examples	Page
Fundamental Content (domain-specific guides)	Business Intelligence & Analytics; Metadata Management; Business Capability Planning; Applying the ADM using Agile Sprints	p. 44
Different architecture styles and methodologies	The TOGAF Leader's Guide to Establishing and Evolving an EA Capability; Microservices Architecture	p. 45
Architecture areas/domains	Environmentally Sustainable Information Systems; Architecture Maturity Models; Business Models	p. 45
Use with other standards and frameworks	TOGAF Content Framework with ArchiMate; TOGAF and SABSA integration	p. 45
Specific verticals or use cases	Cloud Ecosystem Reference Model	p. 45
Practical application	"Template Deliverables" set: Capability Assessment, Communications Plan, Architecture Roadmap templates	p. 45

- All content is downloadable at no additional cost (p. 45).

3.5 Key Advantages of the TOGAF Standard (pp. 46-50)

Advantage	What it means	Page
Comprehensive coverage of domains	Business, Data, Application, and Technology are all addressed, giving a unified, coherent approach	pp. 46-47
Adaptability and tailoring	The ADM is meant to be adapted to the enterprise and to architecture styles. It is iterative (Ch. 13.3) and customizable (Ch. 17)	pp. 47-48
Business and IT alignment	Structured steps bridge the gap, e.g., mapping processes to find redundancies and gaps. Stakeholder engagement (Ch. 14.3) reduces misalignment	p. 48
Facilitating digital transformation	Assess the current state, envision the future state, and roadmap between them. O'Higgins' study links good Business Architecture to transformation success	pp. 48-49
Process innovation	Clear insight into existing processes reveals areas ripe for innovation	p. 49
Common language	Shared vocabulary reduces misunderstanding and supports decision-making	p. 49
Scalability and resource optimization	Modular, so it applies from small projects to enterprise-wide initiatives and avoids ad hoc planning	p. 49

- **The four domains in brief.** Business (strategy, governance, organization, key capabilities); Data (logical and physical data assets and their management); Application (blueprint of systems, their interactions, and their relation to business capabilities); Technology (hardware, software, network infrastructure) (p. 47).

> **Cross-reference note:** p. 48 points to "Chapter 18" for digital transformation. In this book, digital transformation is Chapter 19 and Chapter 18 is Agile Architecture.

3.6 Summary (pp. 50-52)

- The Standard is an open, product- and vendor-independent framework of Fundamental Content (six documents) plus Series Guides, structured to mirror an Architecture Capability (p. 50).
- The TOGAF Library, part of The Open Group Library, helps organizations customize the framework (p. 51).
- Frameworks save organizations from reinventing the wheel, but every organization is unique, so tailoring "is more of a necessity than an option". Selecting the parts that add value saves time, money, and resources (p. 52).

Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition	Page
TOGAF Standard	An open, vendor-neutral EA framework by The Open Group, describing the general approach to establishing an EA	p. 32
Fundamental Content	The six core documents of the Standard	p. 36
Series Guides	Supplementary, faster-evolving guidance on specific concerns, styles, and use cases	pp. 40-41
TOGAF Library	Portfolio of guidelines, templates, patterns, and reference material supporting practical application	p. 43
Reference Library	A class of information in the Architecture Repository that the TOGAF Library supports	p. 44
Building block	A core component of the architecture (e.g., business process, data entity, application system)	p. 38
Artifact	A deliverable component produced during ADM phases: catalog, matrix, diagram, or map	p. 39
Enterprise / Architecture / Solutions Continua	Classification systems for categorizing architectural assets	p. 39
Architecture Capability Framework	Organizational structure, roles, and processes needed to run an EA Capability	p. 39
Business capability	What a business does, often created or changed when the business or operating model changes	p. 34

Figures & Tables Referenced

Figure / Table	What it shows	Page
Figure 3-1	The TOGAF Standard as a set of documents	p. 32
Figure 3-2	Structure of the TOGAF Standard in relation to the Architecture Capability	p. 33
Figure 3-3	Capabilities before and after a video store's digital transformation	p. 35
Figure 3-4	The TOGAF Library	p. 43
Figure 3-5	The TOGAF Reference Library categories	p. 44

Self-Check Questions

Q: Name the six documents of the Fundamental Content.

A: Introduction and Core Concepts; Architecture Development Method; ADM Techniques; Applying the ADM; Architecture Content; EA Capability and Governance (p. 36).

Q: What sits at the centre of the Standard's structure (Figure 3-2), and what surrounds it?

A: The ADM, "the heart of the framework". It is supported by Architecture Content, techniques, and applications of the method, within the Architecture Capability (pp. 33-34).

Q: Must an organization adopt all six documents at once?

A: No. They can be cherry-picked, e.g., the ADM without the Architecture Capability components. A new adopter can start with the ADM, and an organization with an existing framework can blend TOGAF parts in (pp. 39-40).

Q: What is the difference between building blocks and artifacts?

A: Building blocks are the core components that make up the architecture (processes, data entities, applications). Artifacts are the catalogs, matrices, diagrams, and maps produced during ADM phases to describe it (pp. 38-39).

Q: Why do Series Guides change faster than the Fundamental Content?

A: They are produced by The Open Group Architecture Forum through a streamlined, incremental process that responds to industry trends and market demand (p. 41).

Q: Which Architecture Repository class does the TOGAF Library support?

A: The Reference Library (p. 44).

Q: In the video-store example, why is Contract Management drawn with a dashed line?

A: Its name stays the same but its content changes: agreements with DVD/Blu-ray suppliers become agreements with film and series studios (p. 35).

Q: Which TOGAF Library category holds the "Template Deliverables" set, and what does it include?

A: Practical Application. It includes templates for a Capability Assessment, a Communications Plan, and an Architecture Roadmap (p. 45).

Q: What are the four architecture domains, and what does each describe?

A: Business (strategy, governance, organization, capabilities), Data (logical and physical data assets), Application (systems, their interactions, and their relation to capabilities), and Technology (hardware, software, network) (p. 47).

Q: Why does the chapter say tailoring is "more of a necessity than an option"?

A: Because every organization is unique. Selecting the framework parts that add value lets the organization apply the approach to its own situation, saving time, money, and resources (p. 52).

Q: What do the business-needs input and output streams around the Standard contribute to?

A: Business needs from the market go in as problems and challenges. Business solutions and refined needs come out. Both streams form and update the business vision and drivers (p. 34).